

Best Walking Shoes for Arthritis in the UK

Find the best walking shoes for arthritis in the UK. Expert guide to cushioning, arch support, and easy-fasten features for painful feet and joints.

By **Living With Arthritis Editorial Team** · Reviewed by **Clinical Advisory Panel** (HCPC-registered physiotherapy & rheumatology nursing input) · 2026-03-03 · livingwitharthritis.org.uk

Choosing the right walking shoes can make a significant difference when living with arthritis. The wrong footwear can increase joint stress, while well-designed shoes provide cushioning, support, and stability that reduce pain during daily activities.

What to Look for in Arthritis-Friendly Shoes

- Cushioned midsole — absorbs impact and reduces stress on knees, hips, and feet
 - Good arch support — maintains proper foot alignment and reduces fatigue
 - Wide toe box — allows toes to spread naturally, especially important for bunions or toe deformities
 - Lightweight — reduces the effort needed to lift each foot
 - Non-slip sole — important for balance and fall prevention
 - Easy fastening — Velcro straps, zip closures, or slip-on designs for stiff hands
 - Removable insole — allows you to use custom orthotics if prescribed
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Features by Arthritis Type



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For Foot & Ankle Arthritis

Prioritise extra cushioning, a rocker sole (gently curved bottom), and a structured heel counter for ankle stability.

For Knee & Hip Arthritis

Focus on shock absorption and avoid completely flat shoes. A slight heel-to-toe drop (8-12mm) can help with natural walking motion.

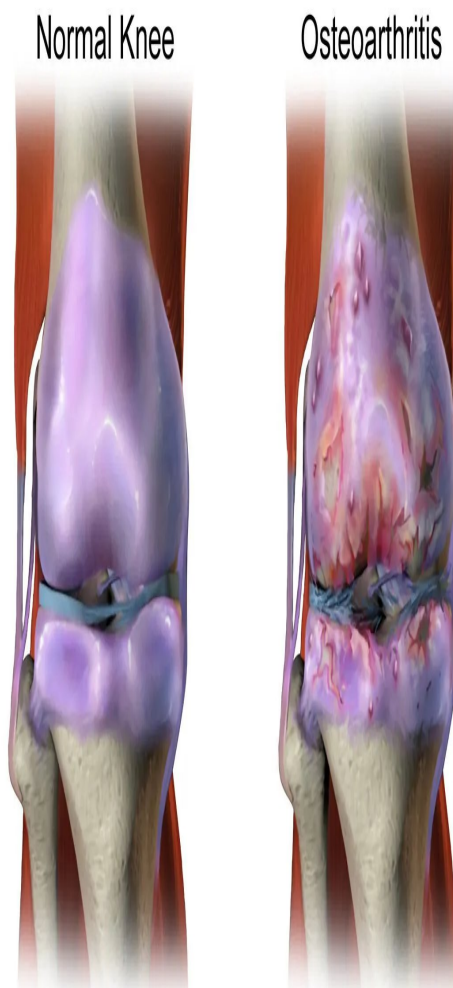
For Hand Arthritis

Choose shoes with Velcro closures, pull-on loops, or elastic laces to avoid the need for tying.

Where to Buy in the UK

- Hotter Shoes — UK brand specialising in comfort footwear with wide fittings
 - Cosyfeet — extra-roomy shoes designed for problem feet
 - Skechers — memory foam insoles and slip-on styles widely available
 - New Balance — excellent range of wide-fitting walking shoes
 - Clarks — UK high street staple with supportive designs
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NHS Footwear Services



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If arthritis significantly affects your feet, your GP can refer you to an NHS podiatrist or orthotist. They can provide:

- Custom orthotics (insoles) shaped to your feet
- Specialist medical-grade footwear
- Advice on shoe modifications

This article is for general information. Consult a podiatrist or physiotherapist for personalised footwear advice.

Q&A

Question: What is the key thing to know about best walking shoes for arthritis in the uk?

Short answer: For arthritis, choose walking shoes with a cushioned midsole for impact absorption and good arch support for alignment. A wide toe box allows natural toe spread, and lightweight materials reduce effort. Look for non-slip soles for balance and easy fastenings like Velcro for stiff hands. A removable insole is useful for custom orthotics.

Question: When should I seek professional advice?

Short answer: If symptoms persist or worsen, pain is severe and unresponsive to usual relief, or you develop new symptoms, contact your GP, physiotherapist or rheumatology team promptly.

Question: Where can I get free arthritis support in the UK?

Short answer: Versus Arthritis: 0800 5200 520. NRAS: 0800 298 7650. Free tools and guides at livingwitharthritis.org.uk.

General information only — not medical advice. Consult your GP or specialist before changing medication or starting a new programme. Emergency: 999. NHS advice: 111. Living With Arthritis UK · livingwitharthritis.org.uk